Mathematical Symbols

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Written by: Jamie Wood
Reviewed by: Dan Finlay
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Mathematical symbols

What mathematical symbols do I need to know?

- Starting with the basic four operations
  - $+$ **Addition,** plus, sum, total
  - $-$ **Subtraction,** minus, difference, take away
  - $\times$ **Multiplication,** product, times
  - $\div$ **Division,** quotient, divide, share
- **Equals** signs
  - $=$ Equal to
    - e.g. $3x + 7 = 19$
  - $\neq$ Not equal to
    - e.g. $2 - 5 \neq 5 - 2$
  - $\approx$ Approximately equal to
    - e.g. $\pi \approx 3.14$
  - $\equiv$ Identical (equivalent) to
    - e.g. $12x + 6 \equiv 3(4x + 2)$
- **Inequality** signs
  - $>$ **Greater** than
    - e.g. $5 > -2$
  - $<$ **Less** than
    - e.g. $\frac{1}{2} < \frac{2}{3}$
  - $\geqslant$ Greater than or equal to
  - $\leqslant$ Less than or equal to
- Other helpful symbols
  - $(\ )$ **Brackets**
    - used to group symbols
    - e.g. $(2x + 4) - 3(x + 7)$
  - 3^x **Powers** (also called indices, orders, or exponents)
    - repeated multiplication
    - e.g. $3^4 = 3 \times 3 \times 3 \times 3 = 81$
  - $\sqrt{\ }$ **Positive square root**
    - inverse of squaring
    - e.g. $\sqrt{81} = 9$ because $9^2 = 81$
  - $\sqrt[3]{\ }$ **Cube root**

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

- used to allow for both a positive and negative answer (two distinct answers)
- $a \pm b$ is the same as $a + b$ and $a - b$
- e.g. $x = 3 \pm 2.5$ is the same as $x = 3 + 2.5 = 5.5$ and $x = 3 - 2.5 = 0.5$

- π Pi
  - the ratio of the circumference of a circle to its diameter

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